PHP's default handler for uncaught `Throwable` objects will emit a fatal error detailing the class of the thrown object and any message it might contain. You can replace the default handler if you want to, using the built-in `set_exception_handler()` function:

```
// Error and Exception classes both implement a Throwable interface
set_exception_handler(function (Throwable $t) {
    print "Oh dear, you fumbled that." . PHP_EOL;
    print $t->getMessage() . PHP_EOL;
});

throw new Exception('ASPLODE');

print "Everyone ok?";

Output:
Oh dear, you fumbled that.
ASPLODE
```

Now, the main thing to notice here is that we didn't get an `E_ERROR` emitted. Which is nice? However, neither did our program continue; not so nice, maybe, but there is a good reason for it. Exceptions are designed to halt your program, unless they are properly caught, because something exceptional happened that makes it difficult/impossible/really inadvisable to continue. Catching an exception and handling the crisis correctly might leave your system in a state where continuing is possible; that's down to you. What has not happened above is a `catch`.

Exceptions "bubble" through a call chain: you can have functions calling other functions, calling other functions… many, many times. Each time this happens the calls "stack" up, and we're going to have a quick look at debugging these call stacks as the final part of this section. When exceptions are thrown, PHP walks back along this stack, or chain, of calls hunting for a `try/catch` construct – the function (or method) throwing an exception rarely deals with it itself. PHP will keep backtracking like this until the call stack is exhausted (at which point it's examining your entry-point script), and then if the exception is still uncaught, it will invoke the exception handler. And this is the problem: PHP now deems execution to be beyond the control of your code, and no matter what the handler does, control will not be returned. A custom exception handler gives you an opportunity to clean things up or (more usually) format a nice chunk of HTML for debugging purposes, but then it's game over.